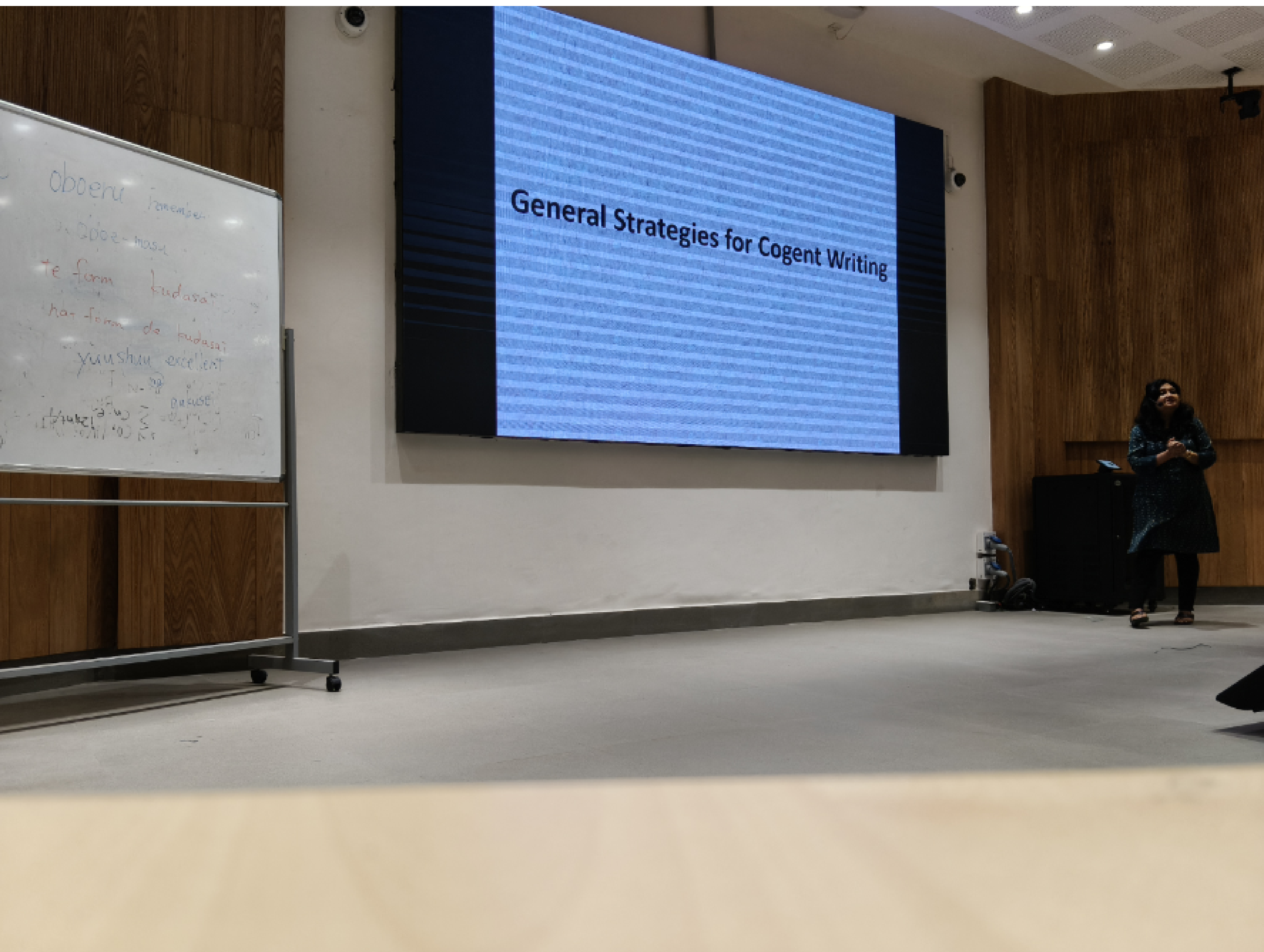




From Stanley Fish's NYT Bestseller *How to Write a Sentence: And How to Read One* (2012)

- "Before the words slide into their slots, they are just discrete items, pointing everywhere and nowhere" (2).
- Some examples from Mark Twain
- "If you tell the truth, you don't have to remember anything";
- "Buy land, they're not making it anymore"
- Student creative writing where anticipation is generated:
"I was already on the second floor when I heard about the box" (from one of Fish's student assignments) (5). Note how the sentence makes the reader want to know more
- Fish points out that as important as it is to follow rules of grammar, precision of thought in writing a sentence is equally necessary.

The Communication Process

- Sender—Encoded Message—Receiver—Decoded Message
- The literary narrative as a story/event/concept to be communicated
- What is successful communication?
- PLOT

Preface to Lyrical Ballads (1800)
William Wordsworth

"... Poetry is the spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings...

...it takes its origin from emotion recollected in tranquility."

Generating Ideas

Defining the Problem and Your Task:

- a) Identify what has to be addressed
- b) Determine how to address it

Note:

- a) Communication is not merely conveying information
- b) Good communication is often socially negotiated problem solving

Brainstorming

- Primarily intuitive
- Can be collaborative
- Generates numerous perspectives
- Leads to evaluation and organization

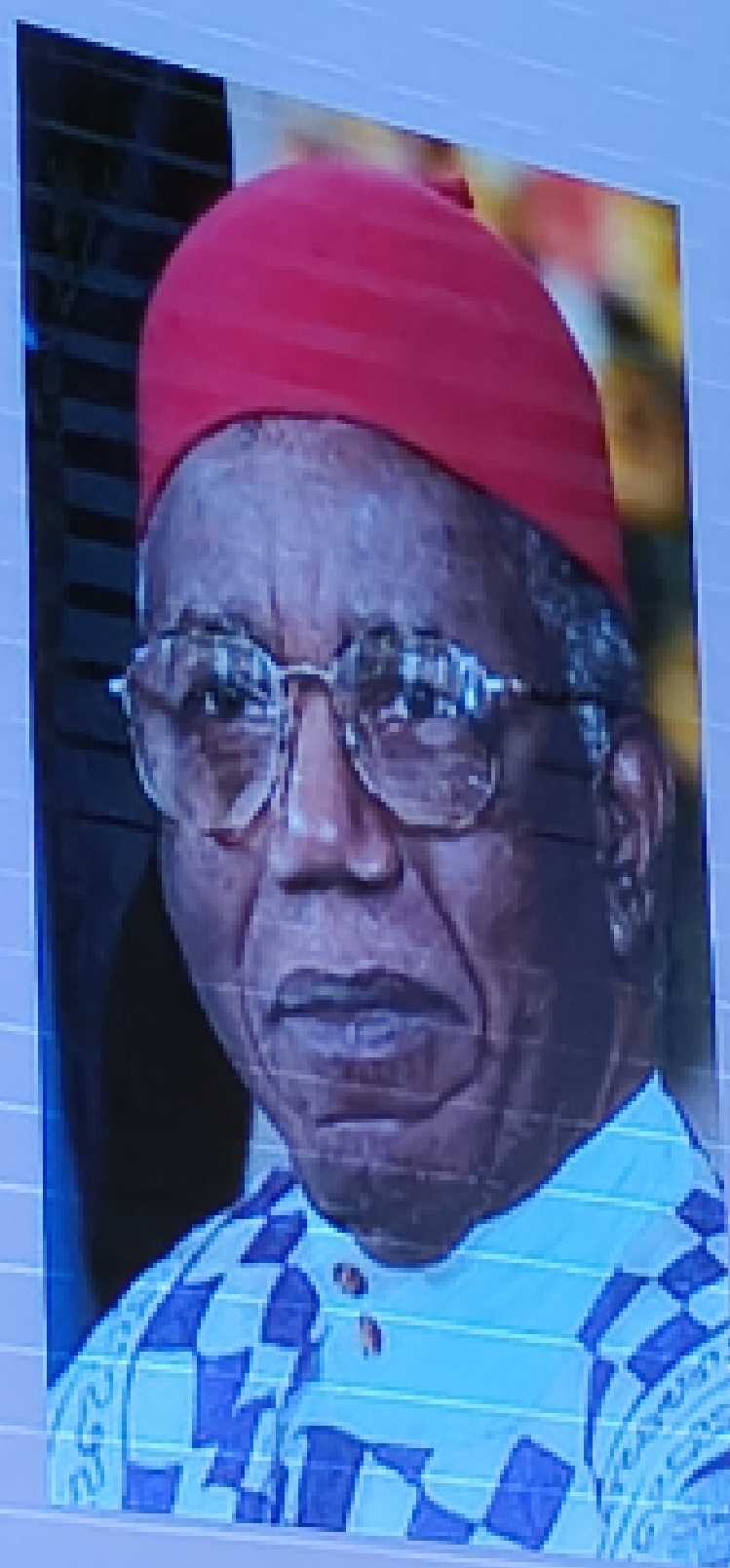
Exploring the Subject Using Aristotle's Common Topics

- **Definition** (Genus/Division)
- **Comparison** (Similarity/Difference/Degree)
- **Relationship** (Cause/Effect/ Antecedent/
Consequence/Contraries/Contradictions)
- **Circumstance** (Possible/Impossible/Past
Fact/Future Fact)
- **Testimony** (Authority/Testimonials/Statistics/
Maxims/Law/Precedents/Examples)

Identifying Audiences and Purposes

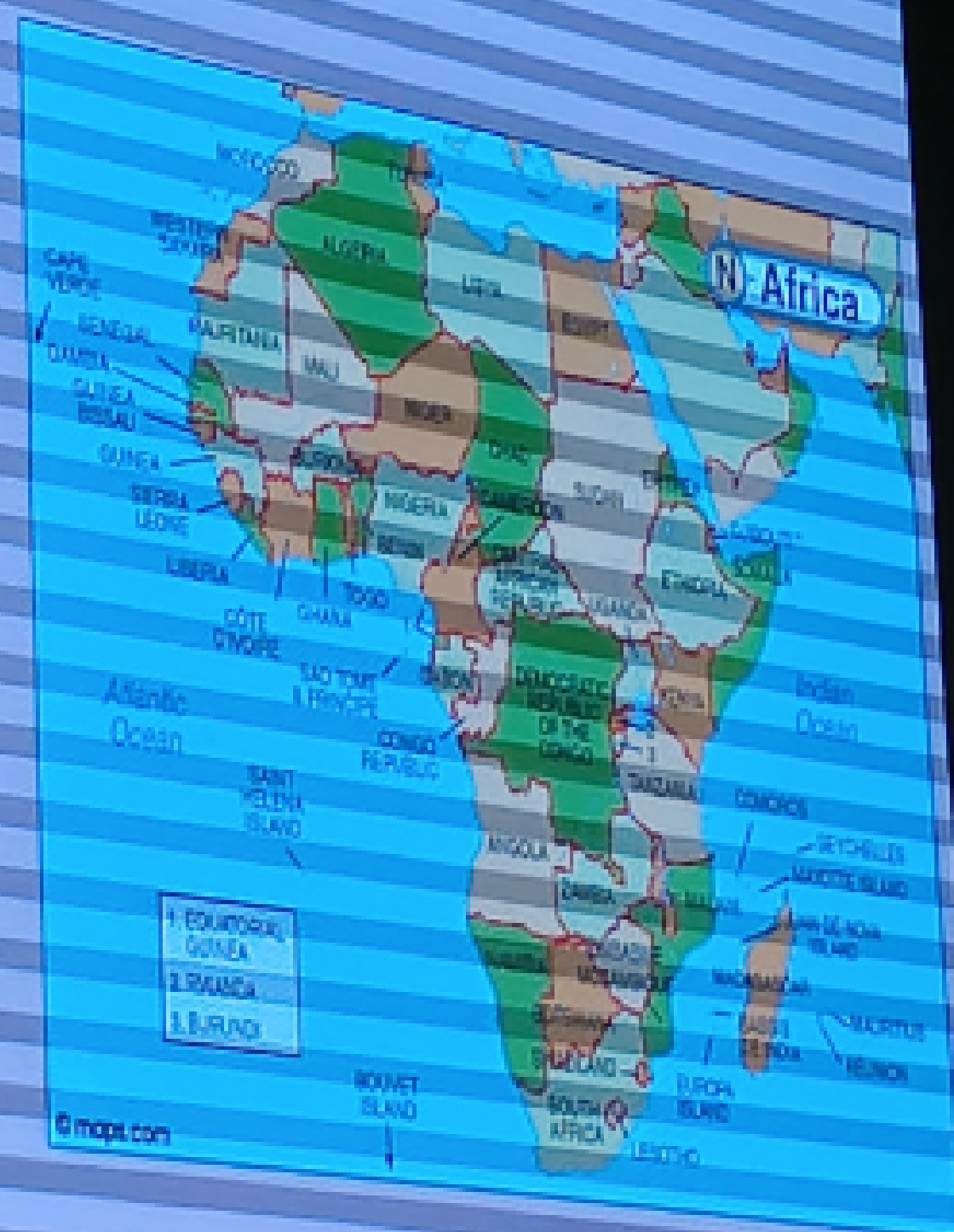
- Identify the uses of your communication and the routes it will travel
- Impact of co-operative/controversial/ethical ideas
- Impact of distortion /incompleteness /inaccuracy /bias

**CHINUA
ACHEBE
(1930-
2013)**



Biography

- Nigerian
- Belongs to the Igbo community of Nigeria
- *Things Fall Apart* (1958): his magnum opus
- Active in Nigerian politics
- Worked to support common people during Nigerian civil-war
- Was professor of Africana Studies at Brown University, USA



Nigerian Civil-War (1967-70)

- What is a civil war?

A war between two factions within the same nation or two countries which once formed a nation

- The Nigerian Civil-War or the Nigerian-Biafran War: Biafra became a self-proclaimed republic but was finally reabsorbed into Nigeria
- Chief causes were cultural and economic arising out of an arbitrary division of the continent by the British

The Short Story and Africa

- Draws from an oral heritage
- Colonization: Slave trade and slave narratives in the 18th century
- Imprints of the Negritude movement in the 20th century
- Negritude is a political and literary movement started in France by the African diaspora in 1930s against French racism and rule (France was the 2nd largest colonizer after Britain)
- Achebe's position: both oral story telling and Negritude